Hiwin Corp. (2049.TW): Price hike impact to continue into 4Q26; remain cautious on order intake sustainability; reiterate Sell

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What surprised us?

Hiwin reported its 3Q26 result and hosted a result call after the close on Nov 10th. The core business (OPI) was 25%/20% higher than GSe and the BBG consensus, with GM coming in 1.9ppt higher than GSe mainly due higher UTR and greater impact from higher pricing on core products (Hiwin raised prices by 7-15% in March, which has a more material impact this quarter). Opex was in line with our expectation (NT$1,502mn in 3Q26 vs. GSe at NT$1,500mn). For earnings, Hiwin's 3Q26 net income was 36%/24% higher than GSe/BBG consensus, mainly on the GM expansion.

Moreover, the company continues to see order intake tracking faster than shipment, leading to longer lead times, with BS at 6.5+ months (was 6 months in 2Q26); the company is also seeing some orders extended into mid-2027, while LG was at 4-6 months (vs. 4 months in 2Q26), which was mainly driven by a recovery in the China market supported by government policy.

Earnings analysis and revisions

Hiwin's 3Q26 core business (OPI) was 25%/20% higher than GSe and the BBG consensus amid higher UTR as well as more positive impact from pricing. GM was 1.9/1.2ppt higher than GSe/BBG consensus in 3Q26. For net income, it was 36%/24% higher than GSe/BBG consensus due to better-than-expected GM expansion.

We maintain our conservative view on the outlook for the linear motion industry as we do not see clear signs of a significant recovery in demand across most end-applications yet (excluding semiconductor industry). We revise up our 2026E revenue by 5% to factor in 3Q26 results and revise up 2027E/28E/29E by 4%/2%/2% to factor in a higher shipment assumption, and revise up our 2026E/27E/28E/29E GM estimates by 1.7/0.4/0.2/0.1ppt as we expect the margin expansion, driven by the company's ability to pass on increased costs through price hikes and prioritize orders with a higher GM.

Investment view

We reiterate our Sell rating on the stock, based on (1) the lack of a meaningful recovery in consumer electronics demand, which could result in softer orders in 2H26/2027, as some demand may have been front-loaded into 1H26 ahead of price hikes, (2) intensifying competition from Chinese local suppliers, including AirTAC, which continues to maintain a stable pricing strategy amid rising material costs and

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has a significantly shorter product lead time (see here), while Hiwin has implemented price hikes across its core products (including both BS and LG), potentially resulting in market share losses, (3) sustained R&D investment in new semiconductor and logistics system-level products, which we expect to keep OPEX elevated over the longer term and weigh on the GM outlook; and (4) current valuation level remaining elevated (still trading at ~35x 1-year forward P/E following a recent 15% share price pullback vs. average of 33.0x in the past 10 years), despite limited near-term growth catalysts.

Overall, we remain cautious on the outlook for Hiwin's core business (linear guide and ball screw), while highlighting increasing cash flow risk from continued investment in the semiconductor/logistics businesses, which we expect to contribute only modestly to earnings in the near term.

We maintain our Sell rating on Hiwin with a new 12m TP of NT$180 (from NT$160), based on an unchanged 20x P/E (in line with Hiwin's average downcycle valuation, or 1std lower than the historical average P/E for the past 10 years), but roll over our valuation base from 4Q26-3Q27E to 2027E, and factor in our earnings revisions.

Exhibit 1: Hiwin 3Q26 comp table

Hiwin (2049.TW)	3Q26			QoQ		YoY		Bloomberg consensus	
P&L (NT$mn)	Actual	GS est.	Diff (%)	2Q26	QoQ	3Q25	YoY	Consensus	%
Revenue	8,110	7,731	5%	7,508	8%	5,995	35%	7,991	1%
Gross profits	2,947	2,660	11%	2,565	15%	1,715	72%	2,807	5%
Operating profits	1,446	1,160	25%	631	129%	411	252%	1,209	20%
Pre-tax income	1,579	1,160	36%	719	120%	573	176%	1,235	28%
Net earnings	1,230	907	36%	579	112%	446	176%	992	24%
EPS, NT$	3.48	2.56	36%	1.64	112%	1.26	176%	2.82	23%
Gross margin (%)	36.3%	34.4%	1.9ppt	34.2%	2.2ppt	28.6%	7.7ppt	35.1%	1.2ppt
EBIT margin (%)	17.8%	15.0%	2.8ppt	8.4%	9.4ppt	6.8%	11.0ppt	15.1%	2.7ppt
Net margin (%)	15.2%	11.7%	3.4ppt	7.7%	7.5ppt	7.4%	7.7ppt	12.4%	2.8ppt

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 2: Earnings revision table

Hiwin P&L (NT$ mn)	2026E New	2026E Old	Diff.	2027E New	2027E Old	Diff.	2028E New	2028E Old	Diff.	2029E New	2029E Old	Diff.
Sales	30,012	28,567	5%	30,316	29,134	4%	31,841	31,210	2%	34,486	33,808	2%
Gross Profit	10,367	9,381	11%	9,923	9,407	5%	10,530	10,260	3%	11,482	11,222	2%
EBIT	4,420	3,463	28%	4,054	3,767	8%	4,512	4,362	3%	4,932	4,801	3%
Net Income	3,678	2,859	29%	3,195	3,009	6%	3,581	3,466	3%	3,905	3,804	3%
EPS (NT$)	**10.40**	**8.08**	**29%**	**9.03**	**8.51**	**6%**	**10.12**	**9.80**	**3%**	**11.04**	**10.75**	**3%**
Ratio analysis												
Gross margin	34.5%	32.8%	1.7pp	32.7%	32.3%	0.4pp	33.1%	32.9%	0.2pp	33.3%	33.2%	0.1pp
EBIT margin	14.7%	12.1%	2.6pp	13.4%	12.9%	0.4pp	14.2%	14.0%	0.2pp	14.3%	14.2%	0.1pp
Net margin	12.3%	10.0%	2.2pp	10.5%	10.3%	0.2pp	11.2%	11.1%	0.1pp	11.3%	11.3%	0.1pp

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: P&L table

NT$mn	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	3Q27E	4Q27E	1Q28E	2Q28E	3Q28E	4Q28E	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E
Revenue	6,379	7,508	8,110	8,015	7,013	7,540	7,950	7,813	7,329	7,972	8,399	8,142	24,263	30,012	30,316	31,841	34,486
Gross profit	2,037	2,565	2,947	2,817	2,134	2,557	2,728	2,504	2,283	2,750	2,892	2,605	6,978	10,367	9,923	10,530	11,482
Operating expense	(1,407)	(1,531)	(1,502)	(1,507)	(1,403)	(1,448)	(1,495)	(1,524)	(1,374)	(1,500)	(1,549)	(1,596)	(5,335)	(5,947)	(5,868)	(6,018)	(6,550)
Operating income	630	1,034	1,446	1,310	732	1,109	1,234	980	909	1,251	1,343	1,009	1,643	4,420	4,054	4,512	4,932
Taxes expense	(170)	(263)	(378)	(308)	(183)	(261)	(290)	(235)	(227)	(275)	(295)	(242)	(354)	(1,119)	(969)	(1,040)	(1,136)
Minority interest	31	31	29	19	31	31	29	19	31	31	29	19	116	109	109	109	109
Net income	579	848	1,230	1,021	579	879	973	764	712	1,007	1,076	786	1,526	3,678	3,195	3,581	3,905
EPS, NT$	**1.64**	**2.40**	**3.48**	**2.89**	**1.64**	**2.49**	**2.75**	**2.16**	**2.01**	**2.85**	**3.04**	**2.22**	**4.31**	**10.40**	**9.03**	**10.12**	**11.04**
Ratio analysis and assumption																	
As % of sales																	
Gross margin	31.9%	34.2%	36.3%	35.1%	30.4%	33.9%	34.3%	32.0%	31.2%	34.5%	34.4%	32.0%	28.8%	34.5%	32.7%	33.1%	33.3%
Operating expense ratio	22.1%	20.4%	18.5%	18.8%	20.0%	19.2%	18.8%	19.5%	18.8%	18.8%	18.4%	19.6%	22.0%	19.8%	19.4%	18.9%	19.0%
Operating margin	9.9%	13.8%	17.8%	16.3%	10.4%	14.7%	15.5%	12.5%	12.4%	15.7%	16.0%	12.4%	6.8%	14.7%	13.4%	14.2%	14.3%
Net margin	9.1%	11.3%	15.2%	12.7%	8.3%	11.7%	12.2%	9.8%	9.7%	12.6%	12.8%	9.7%	6.3%	12.3%	10.5%	11.2%	11.3%
QoQ growth (%)																	
Revenue	-2%	18%	8%	-1%	-12%	8%	5%	-2%	-6%	9%	5%	-3%					
Gross profit	16%	26%	15%	-4%	-24%	20%	7%	-8%	-9%	20%	5%	-10%					
Operating income	100%	64%	40%	-9%	-44%	52%	11%	-21%	-7%	38%	7%	-25%					
Net income	25%	46%	45%	-17%	-43%	52%	11%	-21%	-7%	41%	7%	-27%					
YoY growth (%)																	
Revenue	9%	27%	35%	23%	10%	0%	-2%	-3%	4%	6%	6%	4%	-1%	24%	1%	5%	8%
Gross profit	17%	46%	72%	60%	5%	0%	-7%	-11%	7%	8%	6%	4%	-3%	49%	-4%	6%	9%
OPEX	6%	21%	15%	4%	0%	-5%	0%	1%	-2%	4%	4%	5%	3%	11%	-1%	3%	9%
Operating income	51%	107%	252%	315%	16%	7%	-15%	-25%	24%	13%	9%	3%	-20%	169%	-8%	11%	9%
Net income	20%	527%	176%	121%	0%	4%	-21%	-25%	23%	14%	11%	3%	-23%	141%	-13%	12%	9%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment Thesis and Price Target Risks and Methodology

Investment thesis - Hiwin Corp

Hiwin is the second-largest global linear motion supplier with 18% market share in 2024. It continues to witness decelerating market share growth from 2020 when it started to pursue a deleveraging strategy.

Although we expect Hiwin to continue to benefit from rising demand from the semiconductor/EV industry given the upgrading trend, we are Sell rated, given: (1) we expect a weak end-market demand recovery and high inventory levels for the near term, leading to high pricing pressure and a stagnant utilization rate; (2) continued overcapacity issues in mainland China, where the company has higher exposure (45% in 2024) vs. peers such as THK (24%), and we expect this could lead to further deterioration in Hiwin's revenue/profitability outlook in the near term; and (3) the negative impact from its long-term deleveraging strategy. Hiwin continues to pay back long-term debt and expand capacity to better compete with peers, which we believe will further impact EPS growth and valuation. The stock is currently trading above its historical average valuation (33.0x). We expect its P/E multiple to derate once the market begins to adjust for a prolonged downcycle and expect downgrades to consensus EPS growth/ROE estimates, suggesting high downside risk to Hiwin's valuation.

Price target risks and methodology - Hiwin Corp

Valuation methodology: Our 12m TP of NT$180 is based on a target P/E of 20x 2027E EPS (in-line with Hiwin's average downcycle valuation, or 1std lower than the historical average P/E for the past 10 years).

Key upside risks: (1) Stronger-than-expected EV & semi CAPEX growth; (2) a favorable

linear motion pricing environment in the coming quarters, with a positive supply-demand outlook or longer leadtime; and (3) a faster-than-expected machine tool demand recovery.

2049.TW	12m Price Target: **NT$180.00**	Price: **NT$291.50**	Downside: **38.3%**

Sell

Market cap: NT$93.8bn / $2.8bn
Enterprise value: NT$96.7bn / $2.9bn
3m ADTV: NT$1.3bn / $40.9mn
Taiwan
Greater China Electronic Components
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (NT$ mn) New	**24,262.6**	**30,012.2**	**30,316.1**	**31,841.4**
Revenue (NT$ mn) Old	24,262.6	28,567.0	29,133.6	31,209.7
EBITDA (NT$ mn)	4,001.2	7,098.6	6,925.2	7,451.4
EPS (NT$) New	**4.31**	**10.40**	**9.03**	**10.12**
EPS (NT$) Old	4.31	8.08	8.51	9.80
P/E (X)	53.7	28.0	32.3	28.8
P/B (X)	2.2	2.6	2.5	2.3
Dividend yield (%)	0.9	1.2	0.0	0.0
CROCI (%)	6.6	11.4	10.3	10.7

	9/26	12/26E	3/27E	6/27E
EPS (NT$)	3.48	2.89	1.64	2.49

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 10 Nov 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

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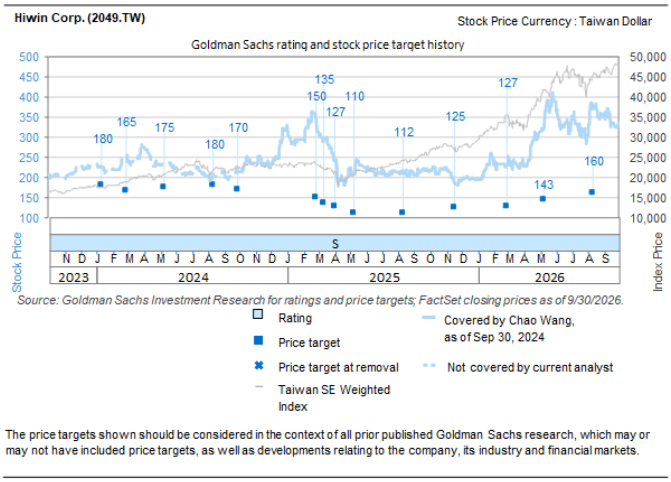
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Target price history table(s)
Hiwin Corp. (2049.TW)

Date of report	Target price (NT$)	Closing price (NT$)
12-Aug-26	160.00	369.00
08-May-26	143.00	319.50
27-Feb-26	127.00	230.00
18-Nov-25	125.00	186.50
12-Aug-25	112.00	213.50
09-May-25	110.00	208.00
03-Apr-25	127.00	245.00
13-Mar-25	135.00	293.00
26-Feb-25	150.00	345.50
29-Sep-24	170.00	220.50
13-Aug-24	180.00	206.50
10-May-24	175.00	237.00
27-Feb-24	165.00	254.50
11-Jan-24	180.00	228.00

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